



Name: _____ Cohort/Batch: _____ Date: _____ Score: _____

RIAK PRACTICE SHEET - 10 CONCEPTUAL Q&A

10 conceptual Q&A Databases

TOTAL: 10 QUESTIONS

Q1 What type of database is Riak and what are its core strengths?

Threat Model

Q6 How do you monitor and tune slow queries in Riak?

Observability

Q2 How does Riak guarantee consistency and handle transactions?

Architecture

Q7 What backup and restore strategies does Riak support?

Lifecycle

Q3 What index types does Riak support and when do you use each?

Configuration

Q8 How do you handle schema migrations in Riak?

Compliance

Q4 How do you design a schema or data model in Riak?

Hardening

Q9 What security features does Riak provide?

Testing

Q5 How does Riak scale horizontally?

SSO / IdP

Q10 What are common anti-patterns when using Riak in production?

Tuning



ANSWER KEY & EXPLANATORY SOLUTIONS

Comprehensive verified answers, best-practice configs, security controls & reference

VERIFIED SOLUTIONS

A1 Riak is a relational, document, key-value,

Mitigation

Riak is a relational, document, key-value, graph, or time-series store. Its strengths such as ACID guarantees, horizontal scale, or flexible schema guide the workloads it is best suited for.

A6 Riak provides a slow query log,

Observability

Riak provides a slow query log, explain/explain plan, or profiling tools to surface inefficient queries. Common fixes include adding indexes, rewriting queries, or increasing cache size.

A2 Riak provides either full ACID transactions

Primitives

Riak provides either full ACID transactions or eventual consistency depending on its CAP theorem positioning. Transaction support varies from none (simple K/V stores) to serializable isolation (relational DBs).

A7 Riak supports logical backups (export SQL

Automation

Riak supports logical backups (export SQL or BSON), physical backups (filesystem snapshot), and continuous replication to a standby. Point-in-time recovery requires WAL/oplog archiving on top of backups.

A3 Riak offers B-tree, hash, full-text, spatial,

Hardening

Riak offers B-tree, hash, full-text, spatial, or composite indexes depending on the engine. Choose based on query patterns: B-tree for range queries, hash for equality lookups, full-text for search.

A8 Schema migrations in Riak are managed

Governance

Schema migrations in Riak are managed with versioned migration files applied in order by a migration tool. Migrations should be idempotent and tested in staging before production to avoid downtime.

A4 Schema design in Riak involves normalizing

Gotchas

Schema design in Riak involves normalizing relations (relational DB) or denormalizing for access patterns (document/key-value). Understanding query needs upfront prevents costly migrations later.

A9 Riak supports role-based access control,

Assessment

Riak supports role-based access control, encrypted connections (TLS), encryption at rest, and audit logging. Always restrict user privileges to the minimum needed and disable anonymous access in production.

A5 Riak scales via replication (read replicas)

Federation

Riak scales via replication (read replicas) for read-heavy workloads and sharding (partitioning data by key) for write-heavy ones. Some Riak implementations handle this automatically; others require manual configuration.

A10 Common mistakes include selecting all

Optimization

Common mistakes include selecting all columns instead of needed fields, missing indexes on frequently queried columns, running migrations without backups, and storing large blobs directly in the database instead of object storage.